

DOCUMENT 42

MASTER SPONSOR PROSPECT RANKING & ASSIGNMENT SYSTEM

How to turn a large sponsor universe into a prioritized, owned and measurable pipeline

Mission: Create one disciplined system for deciding which organizations deserve immediate attention, what the proposed ask should be, who owns the relationship and what happens next. This system supports the 90-day \$1 million cash sponsorship objective and \$6 million qualified-pipeline goal established in Document 41.

ONE COMPANY. ONE OWNER. ONE CURRENT STAGE. ONE NEXT ACTION.

1. WHY THIS SYSTEM EXISTS

A large prospect list is not a pipeline. A pipeline begins when a prospect is qualified, prioritized, assigned, given an appropriate ask and placed into a dated action sequence. The purpose of Document 42 is to prevent duplicate outreach, random prospecting, inflated pipeline values and wasted executive time.

2. THE FOUR PRIORITY TIERS

Tier	Rank / Profile	Typical Opportunity	Ownership	Operating Rule
A	Top 25 / highest strategic value	\$100K-\$250K+	Founder / executive + assigned fellow	Customized strategy; warm introductions; executive involvement early.
B	Ranks 26-100 / strong corporate fit	\$50K-\$150K	Senior fellow / fellow + leadership support	High personalization; escalate meaningful engagement.
C	Ranks 101-300 / growth pipeline	\$25K-\$75K	Fellow-led	Systematic research and outreach; escalate when qualified.
D	301+ / development layer	\$5K-\$25K or in-kind	Fellow-led / nurture	Efficient outreach; do not consume senior closing capacity.

Tier is not permanent. A Tier C company can become Tier A if a strong executive introduction or major opportunity emerges. A famous Tier A name can be downgraded if timing, fit or access proves weak.

3. THE 100-POINT PROSPECT SCORE

Factor	Points	What the Team Must Evaluate
Financial Capacity	20	Can the organization plausibly make a meaningful \$50K-\$250K decision?
Program Alignment	20	How directly does the Student Impact Challenge connect to its current priorities?
Youth / Education / Workforce Fit	15	Does it demonstrate investment in students, education, careers, entrepreneurship or skills?
New York Relevance	10	Meaningful NY workforce, customers, operations, philanthropy or community strategy?
Funding / Sponsorship Behavior	10	Evidence of grants, sponsorships, nonprofit partnerships or community investment?
Decision-Maker Accessibility	10	Can the team identify a legitimate route to the appropriate decision-maker?
90-Day Timing	10	Is there a plausible budget, grant, sponsorship or partnership window within the mission period?
Strategic / In-Kind Value	5	Can the relationship also provide scholarships, technology, travel, media, products, mentors or experiences?

Scoring bands: 85-100 = GO NOW / Tier A candidate. 70-84 = HIGH PRIORITY / Tier B. 55-69 = DEVELOP / Tier C. Below 55 = NURTURE, RESEARCH FURTHER OR DEPRIORITIZE for the 90-day cash mission.

4. REQUIRED MASTER PROSPECT RECORD

Field	Required Entry
Company / Organization	Legal or commonly recognized organization name.
Sector / Category	Banking, technology, healthcare, retail, travel, media, etc.
Prospect Score	0-100 with supporting research.
Tier	A / B / C / D.
Primary Ask	Specific cash ask or proposed range.
Secondary Ask	Alternative cash level or strategically relevant in-kind support.
Strategic Fit	1-3 sentences explaining why the relationship makes sense.
Decision-Maker Department	Corporate affairs, community impact, foundation, CSR, marketing, workforce, etc.
Decision-Maker / Contact	Name/title only when verified or clearly labeled as unverified research.
Contact Path	Verified email, official form, phone, LinkedIn, warm introduction or other legitimate route.
Warm Connection	Person/organization capable of making a legitimate introduction.
Fellow Owner	One accountable operating owner.
Leadership Owner	Founder/executive assigned when required.
Last Action	Most recent material action.
Current Stage	Research / Contacted / Engaged / Meeting / Proposal / Approval / Confirmed / Closed Lost / Nurture.
Pipeline Value	Value appropriate to current qualified opportunity; never inflated by wishful ask.
Next Action	Exact action required.
Next Action Date	Specific date.
Source / Evidence	Current source links/notes supporting fit, programs and contact path.
Risk / Blocker	Budget timing, eligibility, closed grant cycle, no contact, conflict, etc.

5. PROSPECT ASSIGNMENT RULES

- Every active company has exactly one fellow owner.
- Tier A prospects also receive a named leadership owner.
- Before contacting a company, search the CRM for existing outreach, relationships, meetings and prior commitments.
- Do not allow multiple fellows to independently contact different executives at the same organization without a coordinated account plan.
- Ownership means responsibility for research, logging, follow-up and escalation; it does not authorize negotiation of unapproved terms.
- If a fellow is unavailable, management explicitly reassigns ownership in the CRM.
- Warm relationships should be protected. Coordinate the introduction before any cold outreach.
- Major national organizations may have separate foundations, business units or local markets; treat them as one coordinated account unless management intentionally separates them.

6. ASK ASSIGNMENT SYSTEM

Tier / Situation	Primary Ask Guidance	Secondary Path
A - exceptional alignment/capacity	\$150K-\$250K+ where justified	\$75K-\$150K or strategic multi-part partnership
A/B - strong national/corporate prospect	\$75K-\$150K	\$50K-\$75K + relevant in-kind
B/C - strong but narrower fit	\$25K-\$75K	\$10K-\$25K or category-specific support
D / community layer	\$5K-\$25K	Products, services, prizes, local activation
Primarily in-kind fit	Do not invent a large cash ask merely to inflate pipeline	Request the most useful product/service/experience contribution

The ask is a planning hypothesis until discovery confirms budget and interest. Fellows should not present a large number merely because a company is wealthy. The ask must connect to a credible program opportunity and sponsor benefit structure.

7. PIPELINE STAGES — NO AMBIGUITY

Stage	Evidence Required	Counts Toward \$6M Qualified?
Research	Fit being investigated; no outreach yet	No
Contacted	Personalized outreach sent	No
Engaged	Relevant human response/referral or substantive two-way communication	Potentially, after fit/ask validation
Meeting	Qualified discussion booked or held	Yes, if need/fit/ask/timing are credible
Proposal	Defined ask requested, invited or substantively appropriate after discovery	Yes
Approval	Specific support moving through sponsor decision/procurement/approval	Yes
Confirmed	Meets approved confirmation standard	Closed / confirmed, not merely pipeline
Closed Lost	Declined, no fit, no budget or lost opportunity	No
Nurture	Potential future fit but not a current 90-day opportunity	No

8. TOP 100 BUILD PROCESS

Step	Action
Step 1	Consolidate all sponsor lists into one master database.
Step 2	Deduplicate parent companies, foundations, subsidiaries and repeated contacts.
Step 3	Separate primarily cash prospects from primarily in-kind prospects.
Step 4	Score the strongest 200-300 prospects using the 100-point model.
Step 5	Management reviews scores for obvious inflation or weak assumptions.
Step 6	Select Top 100 based on score plus strategic judgment.
Step 7	Identify Top 25 executive accounts.
Step 8	Assign primary and secondary asks.
Step 9	Assign fellow owner and leadership owner where applicable.
Step 10	Complete decision-maker/contact-path research.
Step 11	Map warm introductions.
Step 12	Give every active account a next action and next date.

9. TOP 25 EXECUTIVE ACCOUNT PLAN

For each Top 25 company, create a one-page account brief before major outreach. The brief should contain: company snapshot; why now; public alignment evidence; potential decision-maker team; warm relationship map; primary ask; secondary ask; strongest program story; likely objection; desired first meeting; leadership owner; and next three actions.

10. PRIORITY FLAGS

Flag	Meaning
GO NOW	Strong score + active timing + reachable decision-maker/warm path. Contact immediately.
WARM INTRO FIRST	Strong opportunity but relationship path should be used before cold outreach.
RESEARCH GAP	Potentially valuable, but decision-maker/program/timing evidence is incomplete.
APPLICATION WINDOW	Specific grant/application process exists; record deadline and eligibility.
EXECUTIVE REQUIRED	Opportunity size, relationship or complexity requires leadership.
IN-KIND PRIMARY	Organization's strongest realistic contribution is non-cash.
NURTURE	Good long-term fit but unlikely to close within 90 days.
DO NOT PURSUE	Poor fit, ineligible, reputational concern, no realistic pathway or insufficient value for current mission.

11. DAILY ASSIGNMENT BOARD

Fellow	Tier A/B Accounts	New Research	First Outreach	Follow-Ups	Meetings	Escalations
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____
_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____	_____

12. WEEKLY PORTFOLIO REVIEW

- Re-rank the Top 25 based on new evidence and engagement.
- Review every Tier A account individually.
- Identify accounts with no next action or overdue follow-up.
- Remove inflated opportunities from qualified pipeline.
- Review \$50K+ engaged opportunities for leadership involvement.
- Check for duplicate outreach or conflicting messages.
- Review warm introductions that have not been activated.
- Move weak 90-day opportunities to nurture instead of allowing them to clutter the active pipeline.
- Identify the 10 accounts most likely to move a stage next week.
- Compare actual qualified/proposal/approval/closed totals to Document 41 milestones.

13. ACCOUNT HEALTH SCORE

Status	Definition
GREEN	Current engagement, clear owner, next action/date, credible ask and active movement.
YELLOW	Some fit but stalled response, unclear timing, research gap or overdue action.
RED	No owner, no next action, duplicate/conflicting outreach, inflated value or serious blocker.
CLOSED / NURTURE	Not part of active 90-day pipeline; retained for future relationship management.

14. PIPELINE INTEGRITY RULES

- Never count a silent cold prospect as qualified pipeline.
- Never use the maximum possible ask as pipeline value when discovery indicates a smaller realistic opportunity.
- Never classify in-kind value as cash pipeline.
- Never mark a sponsor confirmed because someone said the program 'sounds great.'
- Never hide a closed-lost opportunity to protect performance numbers.
- Never fabricate a decision-maker, email, giving program, deadline or corporate priority.
- Never leave an engaged prospect without a dated next action.
- Never allow executive attention to be consumed by low-value accounts while high-value qualified opportunities are waiting.

15. MASTER PROSPECT CARD — TEMPLATE

Field	Account Entry
Company	_____
Sector / Score / Tier	_____ / _____ / _____
Primary Ask / Secondary Ask	\$ _____ / _____
Strategic Fit	_____
Decision-Maker Dept.	_____
Decision-Maker / Contact Path	_____
Warm Connection	_____
Fellow Owner / Leadership Owner	_____ / _____
Current Stage / Pipeline Value	_____ / \$ _____
Last Action	_____
Next Action / Date	_____ / _____
Priority Flag / Health	_____ / _____
Key Source / Evidence	_____

Field	Account Entry
Blocker / Escalation	

16. MANAGEMENT PRINCIPLE

The team does not need to chase everyone. It needs to pursue the right organizations in the right order with the right ask, the right owner and the right next action. A disciplined Top 100 can outperform a chaotic list of 10,000 names.

NEXT SYSTEM STEP

Document 43: Top 100 Corporate Sponsor Target Book — research, rank and organize the first 100 named organizations using the rules established in this document.

PROGRAM CONTACT

Frantz Coutard

Founder, Student Impact Challenge

Founder & President, TrendCatch Gives Back Inc.

Email: Info@frantzcoutard.com

Cell: 516-697-6962

Website: FrantzCoutard.com